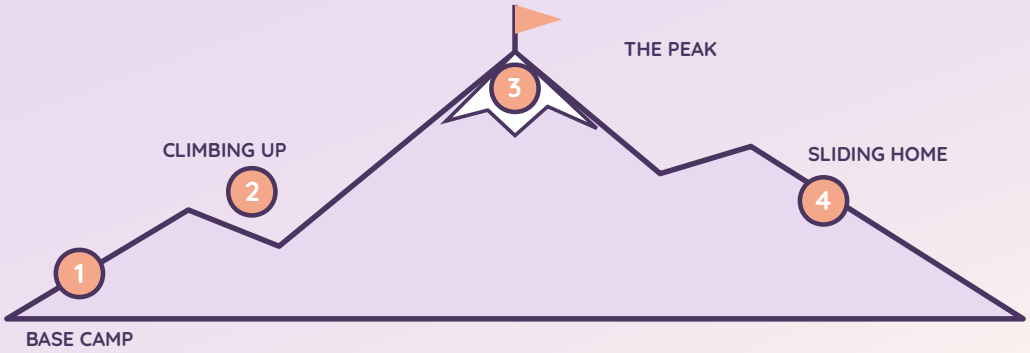
YEARS 5–6 · CREATIVE WRITING

# Guided Creative Story Builder

## Upper Primary Edition




Plan, draft, edit and publish a story with plot twists, figurative language, dialogue and powerful vocabulary.

9 steps

Dialogue + figurative language

AC V9.0 Years 5–6

Author name _____

Year level _____ Date _____

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# Step 1: Spark your story idea

Roll a die for each column, or choose your favourite.

Name _____ Date _____

## How to use the plot generator

Roll a die four times (or pick a box from each column). **Column D** is your secret **twist**: use it only if it fits, or save it for the peak of your Story Mountain.

## The Plot Generator

| Roll | A: Main character | B: Setting | C: Big problem | D: Twist |
|---|---|---|---|---|
|  | A retired lighthouse keeper's apprentice | A drowned city at low tide | The only map is wrong | The helper was the villain all along |
|  | A reluctant time-traveller | A train that never stops | A secret is about to be revealed | It was all a rehearsal |
|  | A rival cartographer | A research base in Antarctica | Two friends want opposite things | A message arrives from the future |
|  | A bush-ranger's runaway horse | A haunted museum after closing | A deadline is only one hour away | The hero is the lost heir |
|  | A cranky robot chef | A floating night market | Trust has been broken | The treasure was never real |
|  | A twelve-year-old inventor | An island that appears once a year | A storm is closing every exit | Everything resets at midnight |

## My rolls

A: _____ B: _____

C: _____ D: _____

## My story spark (or my own brand-new idea)

My story is about _____

who is _____

and their big problem is _____

The theme (big idea) of my story is _____

**Parent/Teacher tip:** Themes to try: courage, honesty, friendship, change, responsibility, fairness. A story with a theme feels more meaningful to read.

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# Step 2: Build a complex hero

A character profile that readers will care about.

Name _____ Date _____

## Example model

**Hero:** Mara Quill, a twelve-year-old lighthouse keeper's apprentice. **Talent:** can read the weather in the clouds. **Flaw:** never asks for help. **Want (outside):** to relight the lamp before the storm arrives. **Need (inside):** to learn that trusting others is not weakness. **Fear:** being left alone in the dark.

## 1. Who is your hero?

Name: _____ Age and role: _____

They live in _____

Talent or skill: _____

## 2. What makes them real?

Their flaw (something that holds them back): _____

Their biggest fear: _____

A habit or mannerism that readers will notice: _____

## 3. Want vs need

What my hero **wants** (outside goal): _____

What my hero **needs** to learn (inside change): _____

Who or what stands in their way (antagonist or obstacle):

_____

## 4. Sketch and label your hero (add details readers can picture)

_____ _____

_____ _____

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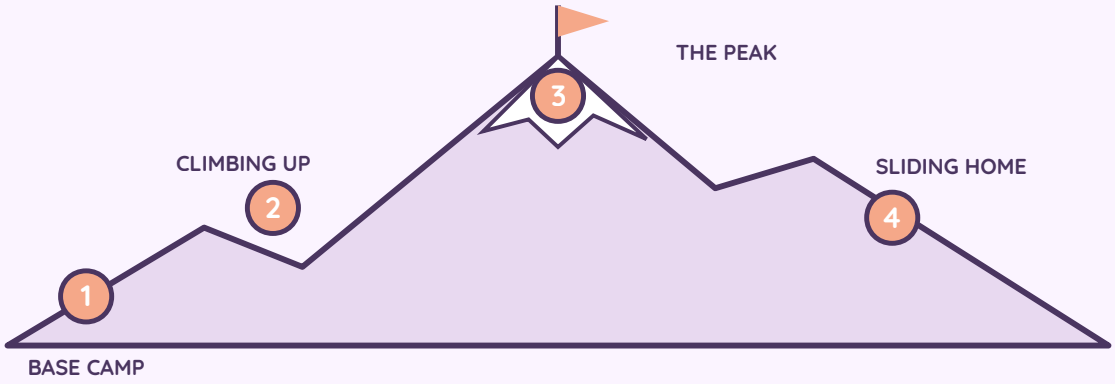
# Step 3: The Story Mountain

Plan the plot so every part has a purpose.

Name _____ Date _____

## Plan the shape of your story

My theme: _____ My hero changes from _____ to _____




## Stage 1: BASE CAMP: Opening and setting

Show your hero's ordinary world, their want, and a hint of their flaw.

## Stage 2: CLIMBING UP: Rising action

What goes wrong? List 2 or 3 obstacles that each make things harder.

## Stage 3: THE PEAK: Climax and twist

What is the most intense moment? How does your twist or choice change everything?

## Stage 4: SLIDING HOME: Resolution

How is the problem solved, and how has your hero changed inside?

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# Step 4: Sentence power

Openers, complex sentences and upgrades.

Name _____ Date _____

## Four kinds of sentence openers

| Time | Place | Action (-ing) | Although / While / As |
|---|---|---|---|
| Just as the clock struck midnight, | Deep inside the shadowy cave, | Trembling from head to toe, | Although she was terrified, |
| Before anyone could blink, | High above the swirling clouds, | Dashing as fast as lightning, | While the storm raged outside, |
| Moments later, | Behind the creaking wooden door, | Clutching the map tightly, | As the lamp flickered and died, |

## Build a complex sentence

Join a **main idea** with a **reason, time or contrast** using a connective (although, because, while, until, as soon as). **Example:** Although Mara was afraid of the dark, she climbed the spiral staircase because the ships needed her light.

1) Although _____, _____.

2) _____ because _____.

3) While _____, _____.

## Boring to brilliant

**Boring:** The boy walked into the dark room and was scared.

**Super:** Clutching the torch with both hands, Leo crept into the freezing, pitch-black room as his heart hammered like a drum.

Upgrade it: “The girl found a box in the garden.” (opener + strong verb + two adjectives + a sense)

## Expanded noun groups

Add detail before and after the noun. **The key → The tarnished brass key with a chipped handle**. Expand these: 1) the door _____ 2) a creature _____

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# Step 5: Show, don't tell

Figurative language and vivid details.

Name _____ Date _____

## Three tools

| Simile | Metaphor | Personification |
|---|---|---|
| compares using **like** or **as**: "The waves roared like hungry lions." | says one thing **is** another: "The night was a black velvet curtain." | gives a human action to a thing: "The wind whispered secrets through the trees." |

## A. Create your own

Simile: The thunder was as _____ as _____.

Metaphor: The old attic was _____

Personification: The lighthouse _____

## B. Told or shown? Rewrite each "told" sentence by describing what the body, voice or actions show

| Told | Shown (your rewrite) |
|---|---|
| She was nervous. | |
| He was angry. | |
| The room was creepy. | |
| They were exhausted. | |

## C. Example

**Told:** Mara was scared. **Shown:** Mara's fingers twisted the hem of her sleeve, and her voice came out as a tiny squeak.

Write a "shown" sentence for your own hero's biggest fear:

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# Step 6: Dialogue that works

Speech punctuation and powerful speech verbs.

Name _____ Date _____

## The five rules

**1.** Put speech inside speech marks. **2.** Start speech with a capital letter. **3.** End speech with a comma, ! or ? before the closing speech mark. **4.** Start a new line for each new speaker. **5.** Use a strong speech verb and show action. (Single or double speech marks: be consistent.)

"Quick, hide behind the crates," whispered Leo. Mara froze. "Where is the key?" she asked.

## A. Fix-it: add punctuation and capitals

1) let's go now whispered Leo the guard is asleep

_____

2) mara hesitated where will we hide she asked

_____

3) we have to run shouted the captain before the tide comes in

_____

## B. Swap "said" for a stronger verb

| whispered | bellowed | muttered | insisted | pleaded | snapped |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Rewrite: "I don't know," said Mia.

_____

Rewrite: "Look out!" said Tom.

_____

## C. Write a short conversation between two characters in your story (at least 4 lines of speech)

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

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# Step 7: Powerful word bank

Circle 6 words you promise to use in your story.

Name _____ Date _____

## Word bank

| Sight | Sound | Touch | Smell and taste | Strong verbs | Feelings |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| tarnished | deafening | jagged | acrid | crept | apprehensive |
| gleaming | rasping | brittle | pungent | lunged | exhilarated |
| murky | eerie | clammy | musty | trudged | bewildered |
| gossamer | muffled | scorching | tangy | hurled | resolute |
| shadowy | echoing | velvety | fragrant | scrambled | remorseful |

The words I will use:

_____

## My own words

Sight: _____

Sound: _____

Touch: _____

Smell/taste: _____

Strong verbs: _____

Feelings: _____

## Sense chart for my setting

My setting: _____

| Sense | What my hero notices |
|---|---|
| I see | |
| I hear | |
| I feel | |
| I smell / taste | |

## Upgrade these weak words

big → _____ nice → _____ walked → _____ looked → _____ scared → _____

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# Step 8: Guided story opening

Hook your reader in the first paragraph.

Name _____ Date _____

## Choose an opening style and write your first paragraph

**Action:** start in the middle of the problem. **Setting:** paint the place with two senses. **Dialogue:** begin with a line of speech. **Mystery:** hint that something is wrong.

My opening style: _____

## Scaffold: fill in each sentence

1) Opener + setting: _____

2) My hero doing something ordinary: _____

3) Although _____, _____ because _____.

4) Then, without warning, _____!

## Now write my opening paragraph (4 to 6 sentences)

**Parent/Teacher tip:** Read your opening aloud. Would a stranger want to keep reading? Underline your best sentence.

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# My story: part 1

Base camp and rising action.

Name _____ Date _____

## Checklist while I write

☐ strong opening hook
☐ hero's want and flaw shown
☐ at least two senses
☐ a figurative language line

## My title

## Write here

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# My story: part 2

The peak and sliding home.

Name _____ Date _____

## Checklist while I write

- ☐ a tense, exciting climax
- ☐ dialogue punctuated correctly
- ☐ my twist or big choice
- ☐ my hero has changed at the end

## Write here

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## Step 9: Edit and improve

Great writers revise. Edit your own story, then a partner's.

Name _____ Date _____

### Edit checklist (tick when done)

- ☐ Every sentence starts with a capital letter and ends with correct punctuation.
- ☐ Speech marks and commas used correctly in dialogue.
- ☐ Paragraphs: a new paragraph for a new time, place or speaker.
- ☐ Verb tense is consistent (past tense).

### Proofreading challenge: find and fix 6 mistakes

the storm hit the island hard Mara dont know where to hide. “run” shouted Leo. They runned to the cave and was safe.

### Bump it up: replace three boring words in your story

| Boring word | Better word or phrase |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |

### Partner feedback: two stars and a wish

★

★

✎

# Final check and publish

Tick each box only when you can prove it in your story.

Name _____ Date _____

## Self-assessment

| I can… | Not yet | Getting there | Yes! |
|---|---|---|---|
| plan a story with a clear Story Mountain | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| hook my reader with a strong opening | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| use figurative language (simile, metaphor, personification) | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| use varied sentence openers and complex sentences | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| show feelings through actions, not just tell | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| punctuate dialogue correctly | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| edit for capitals, punctuation, spelling and tense | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

## My reflection

My favourite sentence was:

_____

The part I am proudest of:

_____

Next time I want to improve:

_____

My story rating: ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

## Teacher / parent comment

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

## Official Author Signature

_____

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# Teacher & parent guide

How to use this workbook.

Name _____ Date _____

## Suggested use (6 sessions)

**1:** Steps 1–2 (idea and hero). **2:** Step 3 (Story Mountain). **3:** Steps 4–5 (sentences, figurative language). **4:** Steps 6–7 (dialogue, word bank). **5:** Step 8 and writing parts 1–2. **6:** Step 9 (edit), final check and sharing. **Support:** use the sentence frames and plot generator, and write one stage at a time. **Extend:** retell a scene from another character's view, or add a twist ending.

## Success criteria

| Skill | Getting started | Meeting | Strong |
|---|---|---|---|
| Plot and theme | simple events | clear Story Mountain | twist and theme linked to character change |
| Openers and sentences | repeats the same pattern | varied openers, some complex sentences | controlled variety for effect |
| Figurative language | none | one simile or metaphor | several, fresh and purposeful |
| Dialogue | missing or unpunctuated | mostly correct | correct, natural, advances the plot |
| Editing | many errors | mostly accurate | accurate, revised and polished |

## Curriculum links: Australian Curriculum V9.0 English

| Year | Code | Focus |
|---|---|---|
| Yr 5 | AC9E5LY06 | plan, create, edit, publish texts (incl. dialogue punctuation) |
| Yr 5 | AC9E5LE05 | create and edit literary texts: figurative language, storylines, characters, settings |
| Yr 5 | AC9E5LE04 | examine imagery: simile, metaphor, personification |
| Yr 6 | AC9E6LY06 | plan, create, edit, publish texts (paragraphs, complex sentences, vivid vocabulary) |
| Yr 6 | AC9E6LE05 | create and edit literary texts, adapting plot, characters, settings; experiment with literary devices |

Check codes on the ACARA website before publishing.

## Model opening (to read aloud)

Just as the clock struck midnight, Mara Quill pressed her ear against the cold stone wall of the lighthouse. Although her fingers trembled, she gripped the rusted lantern like a lifeline. Far below, the sea muttered threats to the rocks, and the wind snatched at her sleeve. "One more flight of stairs," she whispered. "Just one more."

## Answers: Step 6 fix-it and Step 9 proofreading

**Step 6:** 1) "Let's go now," whispered Leo. "The guard is asleep." 2) Mara hesitated. "Where will we hide?" she asked. 3) "We have to run," shouted the captain, "before the tide comes in!" **Step 9:** The storm hit the island hard. Mara didn't know where to hide. "Run!" shouted Leo. They ran to the cave and were safe.

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